

JKBOSE 2026

CLASS 11TH

THE ADDRESS

LECTURE-1

ENGLISH

HUSSAIN SIR



Topics To Covered

- 1 ... Lec. 01. (The Address)
Detailed explanation in Simple words.
- 2 ...
- 3 ...
- 4 ...

The Address *Marga Minco*

- The Address is a short story written by Dutch writer **Marga Minco** who survived the ^{mass killing of Jews} Holocaust in Holland during the Second World War. The story is ^{told} narrated by a young Jewish girl who returns to her home after the Second World War. She visits a woman named Mrs. Dorling, who had taken away her family's valuable possessions for "safekeeping" during the war. But when the narrator comes to ^{to get something back} retrieve them, she realizes something much deeper — that the past cannot be relived just by recovering old things.

⇒ Mrs. Dorling -

The Address *Marga Minco*

- The story opens with the narrator visiting House Number 46, Marconi Street, where Mrs. Dorling lives. Mrs Dorling did not seem to recognise her. The narrator introduced herself as Mrs S's daughter. Still, there was no expression of recognition on Mrs Dorling's face. The narrator doubted whether she had the wrong address. Then she noticed Mrs Dorling wearing her mother's green knitted cardigan. (*Sweater*) Mrs Dorling finally seemed to remember the narrator by her intent gazing at the cardigan. Mrs Dorling had thought that no one would come back again. The narrator told her that she had come, especially on the train to meet her and would like to talk to her for a moment. Mrs Dorling excused herself, saying it was not a ^{*Suitable*} convenient time and closed the door.

The Address *Marga Minco*

- The story goes into flashbacks, where the narrator remembers how various events in her life lead her to this particular moment. It happened long back during the initial years of World War II. She came back home for a few days to find a number of items missing from the house. When she asked her mother about this, her mother told her about an old acquaintance of hers – Mrs Dorling. Her mother was in contact with Mrs Dorling after a long time.

The Address *Marga Minco*

- Mrs Dorling had offered to help the narrator's mother with all their precious things. If the narrator's family had to leave that place, they would lose everything. Mrs Dorling wanted to save all their nice things. So, she took things like antique plates, (high valued) table silver, vases, etc., every time she came to their house. The narrator asked her mother if the issue of final possession of those things was discussed with Mrs Dorling. Her mother felt that even talking about that issue would be an insult to Mrs Dorling's intentions. After all, she was taking such huge risks going out of the door each time with a full bag or suitcase. After her mother gave her a reproving (angrily) look, they never talked about it.

The Address *Marga Minco*

- As the narrator arrived at the station for her return journey, she tried not to look at any of the surrounding things. She was walking in this place for the first time after the war, but she did not want to upset herself with the familiar sights that took her back to memories of her past. She remembers how she had encountered Mrs Dorling long back in the past. It was in the morning after the day the narrator's mother told her about Mrs Dorling. She had gotten up late to find her mother about to see someone out. Her mother beckoned her and introduced her to Mrs Dorling and asked her to remember the address – Number 46 on Marconi Street.

The Address *Marga Minco*

- After the World War, during the Liberation, the narrator did not want to recover or think about those old things at all. The trauma of the war was fresh in her mind, and she was scared that those stored things might just connect her constantly to the pain and suffering. But, as time passed and the situation became better and more stable, and she had a room with a view in which she could sleep peacefully, she began to develop a curiosity for her mother's possessions left at Mrs Dorling's house. After her first failed visit, she decided to try for a second time.

The Address *Marga Minco*



- A fifteen-year-old girl opened the door this time and asked the narrator to wait in the living room. Mrs Dorling was not home, and the narrator was ready to wait. While going to the living room, the narrator saw the old-fashioned iron Hanukkah candle holder, which was never used at her house because it was cumbersome. (Unmanageable) As she moved into the living room, the sight of her mother's old belongings gripped her in horror. A weird feeling seemed to oppress her. She did not dare to look around her much and sat on a chair the girl offered. She recognised the woollen tablecloth. As she ran her fingers through the knitted patterns, she searched for a burn mark that was never repaired.



The Address *Marga Minco*



- The girl offered her tea. As the girl opened a box to take out spoons, the narrator found herself appreciating the box. The girl told her that it was an antique and there were more. The narrator could look around to see more. The narrator felt *hesitant* and kept looking at her beloved pewter plate from her childhood. The girl informed her that they used the pewter plate often and had even once used the antique plates on the wall to eat. The narrator found the burn mark she was looking for. She then responded by saying that it was easy not to keep notice of such nice things in a house when we use them for daily purposes. We only notice when something is missing, or something has to be repaired. The narrator felt her voice was unnatural but went on to tell a story. Her mother had once asked her to help her with the silver. When the narrator wanted to know which silver her mother was talking about, she got to know that the spoons, forks and knives they ate with were made of silver.

The Address *Marga Minco*

- The narrator next asked the girl if she knew what they ate with. The girl hesitated for a moment and went to open a drawer. The narrator knew what was coming next. She jumped to her feet, explaining that she was getting late for her train. She did not want to wait for Mrs Dorling, and as she walked down the passage, she could hear the jingling of spoons and forks.

The Address *Marga Minco*

- From the corner of the street, the narrator looked at the nameplate. The address was correct, but she did not want to remember that address now. She felt that objects linked to memories of former times lose their value when we see them in strange surroundings after being separated from them for a long time. Besides, she found no ^{useful} utility for those things in a small rented room that could not hold many things.
- She resolved to forget the address, and knew that it would not be a difficult thing for her at all.

The Address *Marga Minco*

Conclusion

- "The Address" ends on a powerful note. It's a story of loss, survival, and acceptance. The narrator shows emotional strength by letting go of the past rather than clinging to objects that now feel alien. The story reflects the emotional trauma of war, the struggle to find identity afterward, and the maturity of moving on.

QUESTION



Who is the author of the story "The Address"?

1

Anees Jung

2

Marga Minco



3

Shirley Toulson

4

Khushwant Singh

QUESTION



What was the narrator's purpose in visiting 46 Marconi Street?

- 1 To collect her family's belongings ~~✗~~
- 2 To meet an old friend
- 3 To buy furniture
- 4 To rent a room

QUESTION



Who had taken the narrator's family belongings for safekeeping?

- 1 A relative
- 2 A neighbour
- 3 Mrs. S
- 4 Mrs. Dorling 

QUESTION



How did Mrs. Dorling behave when the narrator first visited her house?

- 1 She welcomed her
- 2 She called her inside
- 3 She ignored and shut the door ~~XXXX~~
- 4 She gave back the belongings

QUESTION



What was the narrator's mother's attitude toward Mrs. Dorling during the war?

- 1 Distrustful
- 2 Nervous but trusting 
- 3 Careless
- 4 Angry

QUESTION



What item reminded the narrator of an old burn mark?

- 1** A tablecloth
- 2** A pewter plate
- 3** A wooden box
- 4** A cup

QUESTION



What is the central theme of the story "The Address"?

- 1 Greed and selfishness 
- 2 Reclaiming property
- 3 Effects of war and letting go of the past 
- 4 Adventure and mystery

QUESTION



'Have you come back?' said the woman. 'I thought that no one had come back.' Does this statement give some clue about the story? If yes, what is it?

ANSWER:

This statement gives us a hint that both the woman and the narrator know each other. The narrative revolves around a girl trying to find her mother's ancient possessions with an adult lady. This girl's mother knew about an upcoming war and so had gradually moved all her valuable belongings to the residence of her acquaintance, Mrs. Dorling. As her mother had expired during the war, the woman Mrs. Dorling did not expect anyone to come afterwards and claim the precious belongings. When the girl came to collect them, she was shocked. The given statement shows that the lady is selfish and does not want to share the antiques that do not even belong to her. She doesn't even recognize the girl as her past acquaintance and refuses to even let her inside her home.

QUESTION



The story is divided into pre-War and post-War times. What hardships do you think the girl underwent during these times?

ANSWER:

The account "The Address" is divided into post-war and pre-war times. The girl belonged to a rich family. The girl's family had a lot of valuable things. There is clear evidence of the difficulties which the storyteller had to experience in these times. During the pre-war times, the girl lived in another place distant from her mother and visited her very rarely. During those times, her mother was worried that her precious things would be lost in the war. They were worried that they would have to leave the house. The girl was in a small hired house with its shutters overlaid with blackout paper. She was unable to see anything outside and the threat of death was also upon them. However, during the post-war period, everything returned to normalcy. The girl could open the shutters of her room and look outside without worrying about anything. She had a powerful urge to look at her mother's properties and so also visited Mrs. Dorlings.

QUESTION



Why did the narrator of the story want to forget the address?

ANSWER:

The narrator desired to forget the address as it prompted her to remember the tender remembrances of her mother, their home and valuable belongings, and her earlier life before the war, which she could never have back. She, therefore, decided to forget the address and move on.

QUESTION



'The Address' is a story of human predicament that follows war. Comment.

ANSWER:

War brings death and destruction with it. The story The Address describes a girl's life in post-war and pre-war times. The war created many obstacles for the narrator both physically and emotionally. She lost her house where they lived and also lost her mother. Her valuable belongings were carried away from them by a stranger who refused to return them. Many pre-war post-war perceptions can be seen in the story. Starting from the loss of life to the selfish and cruel nature of a woman, so many varied emotions are portrayed through this short story.

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Thank
You